



Acts Outpourings Comparison Chart

JERUSALEM • SAMARIA • CORNELIUS' HOUSE

The book of Acts records three significant outpourings of the Holy Spirit as the Gospel moved from Israel to the nations. Each event had a distinct context, demonstration, and purpose in God's unfolding plan.

	 JERUSALEM	 SAMARIA	 CORNELIUS' HOUSE
	ACTS 2	ACTS 8:14-17	ACTS 10:44-48
 CONTEXT	Feast of Pentecost. The disciples were gathered together in one place.	Philip preached Christ in Samaria and many believed.	Peter preached the Gospel to the home of Cornelius, a Gentile centurion.
 WHO RECEIVED	The disciples (about 120) – Jews from every region.	Believers in Samaria (Jews and Samaritans).	Gentiles (Cornelius and his household).
 MANIFESTATION	Sound like a mighty rushing wind; tongues of fire; they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues (Acts 2:1-4).	The apostles laid hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit (Acts 8:17).	The Holy Spirit fell on all who heard the Word; they spoke in tongues and magnified God (Acts 10:44-46).
 LANGUAGES	Known human languages (Acts 2:5-11).	No speaking in tongues recorded.	Tongues spoken as the Spirit fell upon the Gentiles (Acts 10:44-46).
 PURPOSE	A public sign to Israel that Jesus is the Messiah and inauguration of the Church.	To confirm and validate the Gospel's expansion beyond Jerusalem into Samaria.	To demonstrate that Gentiles are equally included in the Gospel by grace through faith.
 RESULT	~3,000 were baptized; The Church was born (Acts 2:41).	The new believers received the Holy Spirit and were strengthened.	They were baptized in water; Peter commanded them to be baptized in Jesus' name.
 KEY VERSE	Acts 2:1-11 "They were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues..."	Acts 8:17 "Then they laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit."	Acts 10:45 "And the believers from among the circumcised who had come with Peter were amazed..."

QUICK COMPARISON

ASPECT	JERUSALEM (ACTS 2)	SAMARIA (ACTS 8)	CORNELIUS' HOUSE (ACTS 10)
 Location	Jerusalem	Samaria	Caesarea (Gentile home)
 Recipients	Jews (disciples)	Believers in Samaria	Gentiles
 Manifestation	Wind, fire, tongues	Laying on of hands; Holy Spirit received	Holy Spirit fell; tongues
 Languages	Known human languages	None recorded	Tongues spoken
 Purpose	Inauguration of the Church; sign to Israel	Expansion to Samaria; confirmation	Inclusion of Gentiles; equal by grace
 Result	~3,000 baptized; Church born	Believers strengthened and confirmed	Baptized in Jesus' name; Gospel goes to Gentiles



THE BOTTOM LINE

These three outpourings show God's intentional progression of the Gospel from Israel (Jerusalem) to the regions (Samaria) to the nations (Cornelius' house). Each event confirms that the Holy Spirit empowers God's people for His mission and that salvation is by grace through faith in Jesus Christ for all who believe.



TEACHER NOTE

Use this chart to help learners see the broader biblical narrative. Encourage them to observe how the Spirit's work advances the unity of the Spirit, and the equality of all believers in Christ.



KEY VERSES

Acts 2:1-4

"When the day of Pentecost arrived, they were all together in one place. Suddenly a sound like the blowing of a violent wind came from heaven... And they were all filled with the Holy Spirit."

Acts 2:5-11

"Everyone heard them speaking in their own language about the mighty works of God."

Acts 8:17

"Then they laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit."

Acts 10:44-46

"While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit came on all who heard the message. The circumcised believers who had come with Peter were astonished, because the gift of the Holy Spirit was poured out even on the Gentiles."



KEY TRUTHS

- The Holy Spirit empowers God's people for His mission.
- God's plan always moves outward to include more people in His grace.
- Salvation is for everyone who calls on the name of the Lord.
- Jews and Gentiles are one in Christ (Eph. 2:14-16).
- The same Spirit, the same Gospel, the same Lord.



RELATED RESOURCES



Articles

See related RC1 articles online.



Visual Theology

View the Acts Outpourings Diagram.



Workbook

Complete the RC1 study guide.



Glossary

See: Holy Spirit, Tongues, Pentecost, Samaria, Cornelius.